

 POUNDS TRANSFORMATION

LET'S TALK ABOUT
CRAVINGS

OVERCOMING CRAVINGS

While cravings can be frustrating, they aren't just random. They're your body's way of sending signals about deeper needs. By understanding the root causes of cravings, you can stop them in their tracks and feel more comfortable.

There are 3 key approaches to tackling cravings:

Biochemical imbalance

Reshaping self-identity/ mindset

Understanding environmental influences

BIOCHEMICAL IMBALANCE

Cravings often stem from your body trying to communicate that something is out of balance.

Here are some common cravings and what they might mean:

Sweet cravings and protein: A craving for sweets might signal a lack of protein, which is crucial for neurotransmitter production, particularly serotonin. Without enough protein, your body struggles to regulate mood and appetite, leading to intense cravings for quick energy sources like sugar and carbs. Add protein to each meal to help stabilize energy levels and blood sugar to reduce sugar cravings!

Savory cravings and cortisol dysregulation: If you crave salty or savory foods, it could point to adrenal gland stress. Chronic stress increases cortisol, which can deplete sodium levels and lead to salt cravings. This imbalance can also disrupt your hunger hormones, making you crave comforting, high calorie foods. Practice stress reducing habits like meditation or yoga to lower cortisol levels and introduce magnesium rich foods like avocado, spinach, or dark chocolate! Need additional support? Try Transform Cortisol

Butter/ Cheese cravings & gut imbalances: These cravings are often tied to a specific bacteria that thrive on fats, or they may signal a need for probiotics and digestive enzymes to support healthy gut function. Support your gut by including probiotic rich foods like sauerkraut or kimchi and consider digestive enzyme supplements if needed. Pair these with prebiotic fibers from foods like asparagus or green bananas to help nourish beneficial bacteria!

RESHAPING SELF-IDENTITY

The way you see yourself determines your decisions. If you view yourself as “too busy to eat well” or “someone who always gives in to cravings”, those beliefs will guide your actions. But identity can change, and it starts with small, consistent choices that reinforce the belief that you are and can be a healthy individual.

Start small: replace one unhealthy snack a day with a better option. Pay attention to how nourishing food makes you feel. The better energy levels, the better focus throughout the day, better mood etc.

Reframe your mindset: Instead of telling yourself, “I can’t have this”, tell yourself, “I’m choosing to nourish my body and feel good in the long term.” It’s all about getting to the point of saying “I can’t have that” to “I don’t want to have that.”

Celebrate wins: Every healthy decision – no matter how small- helps reshape how you see yourself. You will start to slowly change your identity into a healthy individual the healthier habits you start to stack.

UNDERSTANDING ENVIRONMENTAL INFLUENCES

What you see is what you crave. If your pantry is full of chips and cookies, or your coworkers constantly order takeout, it’s going to be much harder to resist.

Don't bring temptations home: A good rule of thumb is this – if you don’t buy it, you won’t eat it. This simple strategy limits your exposure to junk food.

Rearrange your pantry: Place healthier snacks like nuts, precut veggies, beef jerky, or nuts front and center.

Set work boundaries: If your workplace is a hotspot for unhealthy habits, bring your own nutrient packed meals and snacks. If coworkers want to grab takeout, suggest healthier spots or bring your own alternatives.

Surround yourself with more people that prioritize health and wellness. That isn’t to say to ditch your friends and loved ones because they don’t prioritize health but see if you can find a group of people or your select friends that prioritize healthy eating and spend more time with them.